

Our mechanical friends

We built machines to make our lives easier. From simple machines such as a lever to complicated robots that can precisely align and focus space telescopes to capture images thousands of light-years away, humans have made them all. What started as isolated innovations happening in silos across the world has sort of come together now. We now have standard platforms for building robots that can scale really well.

In this month's FastTrack, we're diving back into the field of robotics to learn everything there is about this super-interesting field of study. We'll start off by learning about the origins of robotics, and how it has developed over time and evolved to arrive at its current form. We'll then learn about ROS or Robot Operating System, one of the most widely used platforms for designing robots. It's a really versatile piece of software that allows you to design anything from simple robotic arms to complex multi-rotor machines that can do all the things that a human can do. You can also use ROS to simulate and test how your robot will operate. But the best part is that ROS is an open-source software which not only offers a standard development platform but is completely open to additional software layers. It's an operating system but you can also be termed as middleware because of how accepting it is of third party application layers.

We then dive into the ever-present concern of robots replacing humans. We dive into the arguments on both sides so that you can understand if we